

Stop Cat Night Yowling — Action Checklist

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TRACK THE BEHAVIOR

- ☐ **Track the Behavior:** Complete a 3-day Behavior Log documenting what time meowing started, what you did, and what happened next to identify your reinforcement patterns.
- ☐ **Track the Behavior:** Identify the specific reward your cat is receiving from nighttime meowing, whether it is food, attention, or the door being opened.
- ☐ **Track the Behavior:** Get every household member to commit to the Zero Response Protocol before starting, because one person caving resets the entire training clock.
- ☐ **Track the Behavior:** Record which nights you stayed consistent versus nights when you responded, so you can track whether the protest phase is actually decreasing over time.

ELIMINATE REINFORCEMENT

- ☐ **Eliminate Reinforcement:** Use earplugs, a white noise machine, or a camera with two-way audio to survive the first week without accidentally rewarding the meowing.
- ☐ **Eliminate Reinforcement:** Implement the Zero Response Protocol for a full 14 days without looking at, talking to, or touching your cat during meowing episodes.
- ☐ **Eliminate Reinforcement:** Accept that your cat will escalate meowing during the first 3 nights as the protest phase begins and do not respond at all, not even once.
- ☐ **Eliminate Reinforcement:** Remove all variable ratio reinforcement by never giving in just once, because even one cave tells your cat persistence eventually pays out.

ENVIRONMENTAL SETUP

- ☐ **Environmental Setup:** Install an automated feeder that dispenses 30 to 60 minutes after your cat's current protest cycle so she learns breakfast comes from the machine, not from you.

- ☐ **Environmental Setup:** Replace part of your cat's nightly food portion with puzzle feeders like the Catit Treasure Maze or Outward Hound Nosey Feeder to satisfy hunting instincts during the night.

 - ☐ **Environmental Setup:** Install a low-level night light near the litter box and along hallway paths if your cat is over 7 and showing signs of nighttime confusion or pacing.

 - ☐ **Environmental Setup:** Ensure your cat has access to a covered, elevated resting spot near the bedroom door so she feels secure settling quietly rather than protesting at the door.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.